Workflow Plugin — Design Team Brief

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We are building **Workflow**, a reusable WebCommander plugin that turns incoming events into statuses and actions. Its first job is the Shared Tables Development Award online application with employer or RTO sign-off. Design is needed for the admin setup side; the operational screens already exist as a prototype.

Background

- **Client:** Shared Tables (Kathy Doherty), a long-standing VIP client. Jira: WCS-10892.
- **Request:** move the paper Thierry Marx Career Development Award application (brochure pages 2 to 4) onto their WebCommander site. Applicants upload photos, get an acknowledgement email and see clear errors. Shared Tables downloads applications as PDF or Word.
- **Quote sent:** $1,500 ex GST ($1,650 inc GST), covering award page, editable form, employer sign-off flow, emails, submissions and export, QA and deployment. Kathy is taking it to her board.
- **Already prototyped:** the public award page and multi-step form; the admin submissions queue; the submission record with sign-off timeline; the email the employer receives; the employer sign-off page (confirm or decline).

Requirements

How it works end to end

1. Applicant completes the multi-step form (WebCommander form plugin). On submit, the form sends a "submission created" event to Workflow.
2. Workflow emails the applicant a copy, notifies the Shared Tables team, and emails the employer or RTO a secure sign-off link (no login).
3. Status becomes Awaiting sign-off. Reminders go every 3 days, up to 3, until the endorser responds or the link expires at closing (Wed 8 Jul 2026, 5:00pm AEST).
4. The endorser confirms or declines. Status becomes Approved, Declined or Expired, and the applicant is told.
5. Admins view, resend, print and export submissions as PDF or Word, one at a time or in bulk.

Application form (form plugin)

- Multi-step with category-driven fields, word limits, photo and file uploads, inline errors and a review step.
- Server-side draft saving with an emailed "resume your application" link, so it works on any device.
- No sign-off section inside the form; sign-off happens by email.

Workflow plugin (the framework)

- Follows the Exsited/AutoBill model: states (Begin, working, End) joined by transitions; transitions are manual or automatic; each can have pre-checks and post-functions (send email, generate document, update a field).
- Approval step supports a specific user, a user group (sequential or parallel), and new for this job, **an approver taken from a field on the record**, who acts through a single-use, expiring link.
- Reminders and expiry run as timers on the approval step.
- Statuses are written back to the form submission so the existing list can filter by them.
- Every action is logged per record; failed steps can be retried.
- Phase 1: workflows are set up from a template through settings panels. Phase 2: the visual drag-and-drop builder.

Admin

- Workflows list and a workflow editor (flow of states on the left, settings on the right, Save draft, Test, Publish).
- Email templates with merge fields and preview, and a PDF/Word document template.
- Submissions queue and record view (already prototyped), plus resend and change endorser email.

Roles (on existing WebCommander users)

Role	Can
Workflow Admin	Set up, test and publish workflows; manage access
Workflow Manager	View, resend, change status with a reason, print and export submissions
Workflow Viewer	View and download only
External endorser	Confirm or decline one application through its link

Decisions made

Decision	Detail
Sign-off is automated	Endorser signs via an emailed link; the in-form sign-off section is removed
One sending domain	sharedtables.com.au only
Draft saving	Server-side, with a resume link by email
Exsited reuse	Same concepts, adapted to WebCommander where it makes sense
Phase 1 scope	Engine plus template-based setup; visual builder in Phase 2
Prototype data	Names and dates are test data
Client assets	Logos and images are not a design blocker now

References

References: existing prototypes (website form, admin view and employer confirmation) on WCS-10892 · Exsited workflow specs: B003 Customisation and Workflow Engine, B003 Workflow Builder, B003 Milestone Mechanism, DA14 Approval profile, DA15 Approval User Groups · Claude Design prompt: Workflow Plugin — Admin UI Spec (Claude Design brief)